Specification of the controlled designation of origin “HERMITAGE” or “L’HERMITAGE” or “ERMITAGE” or “L’ERMITAGE”

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CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” or “l’Hermitage”, with or without an H, initially recognised as a designation of origin by the judgment of the Valence court dated 25 June 1936 and recognised as a controlled appellation by the decree of 4 March 1937.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the term “vin de paille” (straw wine) for wines meeting the regulatory production conditions laid down for that term (Annex XII of Regulation (EC) No 607/2009) and the production conditions laid down in the present specification.

III. – Colour and types of product

1° – The controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” or “l’Hermitage”, with or without an H, is reserved for still white and red wines.

2° – The term “vin de paille” is reserved for still white wines.

VI. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines; the harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”, are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Drôme department, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024: Crozes-Hermitage, Larnage and Tain-l’Hermitage.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The grapes come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 2 June 1989.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, as well as for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”, is made up of the territory of the following communes, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024:

Ardèche department: Alboussière, Andance, Ardoix, Arlebosc, Arras-sur-Rhône, Boffres, Publié au BO agri du MASAF le 19 décembre 2024 2 Bogy, Champagne, Champis, Charmes-sur-Rhône, Charnas, Châteaubourg, Cheminas, Colombier-le- Cardinal, Cornas, Eclassan, Etables, Félines, Gilhac-et-Bruzac, Glun, Guilherand-Granges, Lemps, Limony, Mauves, Ozon, Peaugres, Peyraud, Plats, Quintenas, Saint-Barthélemy-le-Plain, Saint-Cyr, Saint-Georges-les-Bains, Saint-Romain-d’Ay, Saint-Romain-de-Lerps, Sarras, Sécheras, Serrières, Saint-Désirat, Saint-Etienne-de-Valoux, Saint-Jean-de-Muzols, Saint-Péray, Soyons, Talencieux, Thorrenc, Toulaud, Tournon-sur-Rhône, Vernosc-lès-Annonay, Vinzieux, Vion

Drôme department: Albon, Andancette, Beaumont-Monteux, Beausemblant, Bourg-les- Valence, Chanos-Curson, Chantemerle-les-Blés, Châteauneuf-sur-Isère, Chavannes, Clérieux, Erôme, Gervans, Granges-les-Beaumont, Laveyron, Mercurol-Veaunes, Ponsas, Pont-de-l’Isère, La Roche-de- Glun, Saint-Barthélemy-

de-Vals, Saint-Jean-de-Galaure, Saint-Rambert-d'Albon, Saint-Uze, Saint- Vallier, Serves-sur-Rhône, Triors, Valence

Isère department: Chonas-l'Amballan, Le Péage-de-Roussillon, Reventin-Vaugris, Les Roches-de-Condrieu, Sablons, Saint-Alban-du-Rhône, Saint-Clair-du-Rhône, Saint-Maurice-l'Exil, Salaise-sur-Sanne, Seyssuel, Vienne

Loire department: Bessey, La Chapelle-Villars, Chavanay, Chuyer, Lupé, Maclas, Malleval, Pélussin, Roisey, Saint-Michel-sur-Rhône, Saint-Pierre-de-Bœuf, Saint-Romain-en-Jarez, Vérin

Rhône department: Ampuis, Condrieu, Les Haies, Loire-sur-Rhône, Longes, Sainte-Colombe, Saint-Cyr-sur-le-Rhône, Saint-Romain-en-Gal, Tupin-et-Semons

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The red wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: syrah N; - accessory varieties: marsanne B, roussanne B.

b) – The white wines come from the marsanne B and roussanne B varieties.

c) – The wines liable to benefit from the term "vin de paille" come from the marsanne B and roussanne B varieties.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

- For the red wines, the proportion of the syrah N variety is greater than or equal to 85 % of the grape varieties of the holding. The presence of the accessory varieties is authorised as a mixture of plants in the vines planted with syrah N within the limit of a proportion of 15 % of the plants; - The conformity of the grape varieties of the holding is assessed over the totality of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin and taking into account the situation of the parcels co-planted with a white variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.
The vines present a minimum planting density of 6,000 plants per hectare. The vines may not present a spacing between rows greater than 2.0 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row less than 0.8 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.
The vines are pruned with a maximum of 9 free eyes (buds) per plant, according to the following techniques: - short spur pruning (goblet, Royat cordon with one or two arms); - single or double Guyot pruning.

c) – Trellising, foliage-height and staking rules.
The vines are trained either on stakes or in "raised single-plane trellising". - For vines trained in "raised single-plane trellising", the height of the trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows. The height of trellised foliage is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit. - For vines trained on stakes, the staking height is at least 1.50 metre. This height is measured between the ground level and the top of the stake.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 6,500 kilograms per hectare. - Where irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 5,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Thresholds for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels must be managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir:

a) – On the parcels apt for the production of the controlled designation of origin, the works for controlling water flow and the elements ensuring the integrity and durability of the soils (low walls, terraces, banks, etc.) are maintained according to usage;

b) – Only developments or works that do not bring a substantial modification of the structuring elements (low walls, terraces, embankments, banks, etc.) of a parcel of the delimited parcel area are authorised.

c) – The control of the spontaneous vegetation is carried out, from 1 September to 1 February, either by soil tillage or by equipment ensuring a precise localisation of the treatment products.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code. Any fixed irrigation installation situated inside the plantings, as well as any sprinkler or drip irrigation system, is prohibited. “Fixed irrigation installation” means any irrigation installation present on a vine parcel outside the authorised irrigation period.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions. The grapes are harvested manually.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest. The bunches of grapes are transported whole to the place of vinification.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes and minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The sugar content of the grapes and the minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume meet the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES, TERM	**MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)**	**MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
Red wines	171	10.5 %
White wines	170	11 %
Wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”	170	19.5 %

b) – Minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume. The wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille” present a minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume of 12.5 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

a) – The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 40 hectolitres per hectare for the red wines.

b) – The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 45 hectolitres per hectare for the white wines.

c) – The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 15 hectolitres per hectare for the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”.

2° – Limit yield

a) – The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 46 hectolitres per hectare for the red and white wines.

b) – The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 15 hectolitres per hectare for the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

4° – Particular provisions

a) – If, for one and the same determined area of vines in production, both the controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” or “l’Hermitage”, with or without an “H”, and the controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” or “l’Hermitage”, with or without an “H”, supplemented by the term “vin de paille” are claimed, the quantity declared under the controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” or “l’Hermitage”, with or without an “H”, must not be greater than the difference between that liable to be claimed under this controlled designation of origin and that declared under the controlled designation of origin supplemented by the term “vin de paille”, to which is applied a coefficient K equal to the quotient of the yield authorised for the controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” or “l’Hermitage”, with or without an “H” (white wines) by the yield authorised for the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”;

b) – In the event of an enrichment authorisation granted for a given harvest, the yield can only be reduced.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local usages.

a) – Blending of varieties. For the red wines, the proportion of the syrah N variety is greater than or equal to 85 % of the blend, and the wines elaborated from the white varieties and the syrah N variety are vinified by blending of the grapes concerned, respecting this same proportion.

b) – Malolactic fermentation. The red wines present, at the packaging stage, a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards. At the packaging stage: - with the exception of the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”, the wines present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 3 grams per litre, for wines presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 14 %, and less than or equal to 4 grams per litre, for wines presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume greater than 14 %; - the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille” present a volatile acidity content less than or equal to 30 milliequivalents per litre.

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. - The use of pieces of wood is prohibited. - The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, the following total alcoholic strength by volume:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	TOTAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
White wines	14 %
Red wines	13.5 %

e) – Prohibited equipment. Continuous presses are prohibited.

f) – Vat capacity. Every operator has a vinification vat capacity at least equal to 0.8 times the product of the yield referred to at VIII (1°) by the area of the vines intended to be vinified in the cellar.

g) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

a) – The grapes intended for the elaboration of the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille” undergo an off-vine raisining (“passerillage”) for a minimum duration of 45 days between the effective date of harvest and the date of pressing, either on beds of straw or on racks, or hung in premises ventilated naturally or artificially, any air-heating device being prohibited;

b) – At the moment of pressing, the grapes intended for the elaboration of the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille” present a sugar content greater than 350 grams per litre of must.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) The corks used have a length greater than or equal to 44 millimetres.

b) – For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates an identified place for the storage of the packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumers

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer. - The white and red wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated on a fragment of a granitic massif that the Rhône separated from the Ardèche mountain, thus creating a unique islet in the Drôme department, emblematic of the landscape by its extreme visibility from the main communication networks of the Rhône Valley (A7 motorway and National Road 7, the Rhône river, the railway). The southern extremity of this relief forms the Pierreaiguille rock (335 metres of altitude) which marks the western limit of the hillside, thus closing the Rhône Valley between the Tain and Tournon defile and that of the Bouterne, towards the east where the granitic bedrock is covered by more recent formations.

The major part of its territory encompasses the eponymous hillside which extends essentially over the commune of Tain-l’Hermitage and spills over onto a tiny part of the neighbouring communes of Crozes-Hermitage and Larnage. This zone is thus set over 3 communes of the Drôme department, located on the left bank of the Rhône, within which parcels precisely delimited for the harvesting of the grapes allow an optimal management of the plant, a control of the vigour and of the production potential reflected in practices of low yields arising from short pruning, by a management of the planting densities and of the training methods adapted to these hillsides.

Over a restricted area, one encounters: - To the west, terrains of Primary origin made up of granite, covered with micaschists and gneiss which, through degradation, have given fragile sandy-clayey granitic-arena soils. - To the east, terrains of Quaternary origin formed essentially of different levels of ancient alluvial terraces superposed during the melting of the glaciers (Alpine diluvium). The oldest deposits are situated highest in the landscape, whereas the most recent deposits are the closest to the present Rhône Valley. At the end of the Quaternary, violent winds, coming from the North, added loess (calcareous aeolian deposits) onto these formations. They subsist only in the sites where they have not been taken up again by erosion, on the flats at the top of the hillside.

Oriented perpendicularly to the axis of the Rhône Valley, the vineyard is particularly well protected from the northern winds by the abrupt hillsides, favouring the installation of a very hot mesoclimate which has notably allowed a few "relict" olive trees to establish themselves in the "Beaumes" quarter. This privileged situation, moreover, eliminates the risks of spring frosts.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Much evidence attests, on the one hand to the Roman presence at Tain-l'Hermitage (the Taurobolium of Tain-l'Hermitage, the vestiges of the temple of Hercules between the present communes of Tain-l'Hermitage and Mercurol, etc.) and on the other hand to the anteriority of the cultivation of the vine and of wine in the Rhône Valley. Indeed, Tain-l'Hermitage, like the whole perimeter of the appellations of the northern Rhône Valley, belonged to the territory of the Allobroges. In this sector, the cultivation of the vine would go back at least to the period of the Roman occupation, that is to say between 124 BC (submission of the Allobroges) and 61 BC (defeat of the last revolt of the Allobroges). From this date, the Allobroges become Viennese, or the city of Vienne.

While the geographer STRABO evokes the cultivation of the vine in the Rhône Valley in 30 BC without, however, specifying its northern limit, on the other hand numerous ancient authors including the physician CELSUS, the naturalist PLINY THE ELDER, the historian PLUTARCH, the agronomist COLUMELLA and the poet MARTIAL mention "l'Allobrogica", a wine of Vienne produced among the Allobroges. "L'Allobrogica" also designates a variety whose DNA study would make it a distant cousin of the syrah N variety, itself emblematic of the neighbouring controlled designations of origin.

Among the numerous legends surrounding the origins of this famous vineyard, one, reported by ALBERT du BOY in the album of the Dauphiné (1836), relates the installation in the vineyard, around 1224, of the man named Henri GASPARD de STERIMBERG, a knight returning from the Albigensian crusade who, after having meditated in the chapel of Saint-Christophe, is said to have ended up settling there to become the first hermit of this vineyard. This account remains apocryphal, but the archives of the town of Tain-l'Hermitage indeed authenticate the installation of several hermits in the hillside of the Ermitage from 1598. Other writings corroborate the link between the existence of hermits and the change of name of the hillside known as "Saint-Christophe" to the hillside of the Ermitage, which would later give its name to the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage".

The vineyard bears the marks of an ancient and omnipresent intervention of generations of winegrowers led, sometimes to build a network of channels to evacuate the excess rains towards the Rhône, sometimes to build low walls, with the original aim of guaranteeing the durability of the soil made up of unstable granitic arenas. In the 19th century, the vineyard is held by notables who organise country dinners in the vineyard and build for this purpose "follies" (constructions in vogue during the Romantic period), of which a few vestiges are still found today (pergola, temple, etc.). The development of a small built heritage and the upkeep of the vines have thus shaped an original viticultural landscape of undeniable aesthetic qualities, integrating cultivation conditions, planting densities, pruning method, as well as harvesting conditions adapted to the topographical constraints and to the abrupt hillsides.

The syrah N, marsanne B and roussanne B (more anecdotal) varieties are emblematic varieties and the only ones authorised in the northern controlled designations of origin of the Rhône Valley on this bank of the Rhône. The work of man has been to adapt this restricted choice of varieties to a palette of diversified soils. Thus, the syrah N variety is established mainly in the western part of the granitic hillside, and even on alluvial formations. The white varieties (essentially marsanne B) are concentrated on the more calcareous soils.

From 1881, the mobilisation of the winegrowers to rebuild the vineyard ravaged by the phylloxera crisis restored its titles of nobility to the wine of the Hermitage. After the notables of the prosperous years, a new wave of owners and merchants appears. At this period the first unions are born, and notably the agricultural union of Tain-l'Hermitage (1890). The economic recession and the wine crisis (overproduction) between 1920 and 1930 oblige the human community to organise itself further. Thus, the main structures of viticulture at Tain-l'Hermitage date from this difficult period: the "Union of the winegrowers of the canton of Tain-l'Hermitage, producers of great wines" (1927), the "Cooperative cellar of fine wines of Tain-l'Hermitage" (1933), etc. But it is unquestionably the foundation of the Union for the protection of the "Hermitage" appellation (1930), whose primary aim was to carry out its delimitation, that definitively opened the way towards the official recognition of the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage". The vineyard comprises, in 2009, 137 hectares in production and claimed, shared between 1 cooperative cellar, 7 merchants and 17 private cellars. The red wines represent, also in 2009, 70 % of the production.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

The red wines are wines, elaborated essentially from the syrah N variety, presenting an intense colour, rich, expressive, complex aromas, generally of ripe fruit, spices, undergrowth. On the palate, they are powerful and tannic. This balance gives them a good keeping capacity. The vineyard is worked by numerous owners possessing parcels scattered throughout the delimited parcel area. This leads the winegrowers to favour the complementarity of the soils more than their diversity.

The white wines are distinguished by a great aromatic power (white flower, spices, honey, etc.), a fine balance between acidity and a certain mellowness, without the presence of fermentable sugars.

Finally, the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage" distinguishes itself from the other controlled designations of origin of the northern Rhône Valley by a production of white wines benefiting from the term "vin de paille", a production nevertheless confidential in terms of volume. Harvested at optimum ripeness, the white grape is set to dry at ambient and natural temperature for a minimum of 45 days. This drying makes it possible to reach an important concentration of sugars. After a delicate pressing, the very rich musts ferment slowly and incompletely to give an exceptional wine. These wines present an amber robe, a sweet flavour, a marked alcoholic richness, complex and intense aromas in which candied fruits dominate, generally accompanied by notes of smoke, exotic fruit, vanilla, honey, etc.

3° – Causal interactions

Situated on the left bank of the Rhône, the geographical area benefits from a favourable mesoclimate, linked to the particular topography of this very open hillside, exposed due south and close to the river, and from a geo-pedological complex requiring the permanent intervention of man for the harmonious development of terraces and low walls. This environment offers the three varieties (syrah N, marsanne B and roussanne B) optimal conditions of development and ripeness and makes it possible to produce original wines.

This very hot mesoclimate, mastered by the winegrowers, allows the expression of aromas of ripe fruit, spices and undergrowth in complex red wines for long keeping, of aromas of white flowers and honey in structured white wines with subtle scents, as well as the appearance of aromas of candied fruit in the white wines from raisined grapes, heady and intense, benefiting from the term "vin de paille".

The transmission of the usages of vine cultivation in respect of the soils from Antiquity to the present day has enabled the vineyard of "l'Hermitage" to safeguard its physiognomy over the ages. The classification of the site of the hillsides of "l'Hermitage" by decree of 5 June 2013 demonstrates its heritage interest, due notably to the preservation of the elements structuring the landscape (low walls, terraces, banks), which are set out in the present specification. Likewise, the rules relating to the training method and to the harvest contribute to the maintenance of the vineyard on the hillsides.

As early as June 1936, the Valence court granted the designation of origin for the first time, thus recognising the work of the human community formed around the installation and then the safeguarding of the vineyard (planting by hermits then post-phylloxera restoration) and the defence of its wines (attempt at usurpation of the renown).

Still today, the controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” is one of the jewels of the controlled designations of origin of the northern Rhône Valley and the only controlled designation of origin of this sector whose reputation was built as much on the white wines as on the red wines. In 1791, Thomas Jefferson, then ambassador of the United States to France, an informed oenologist and lover of French wines, describes the wine of “l’Hermitage” as: “The first wine in the world without exception”. When he becomes the third President of the United States, he regularly imports wines of “l’Hermitage” and writes in 1817 that the white wine of “l’Hermitage” should be reserved for great occasions (“It being chiefly for a bonne bouche” — in French in the text).

Beyond its privileged geographical situation, which favours not only the production but also the movement and diffusion of the wines, the aesthetics of this viticultural landscape have greatly contributed to its reputation. The winegrowers and the wine merchants, moreover, quickly knew how to take advantage of this showcase by inscribing their names on the retaining walls, then on walls placed higher up in the hillside, visible from even further away. The beginnings of this “advertising practice” coincide with the development of the railway between 1850 and 1855.

Beyond these elements highlighting the synergy between the reputation of the wine and the renown of its vineyard, it is fitting to cite Ardouin Dumazet who, in his Voyage en France of 1895, underlines the notoriety and the qualities of the Hermitage: “The wines of the Hermitage have always been of renown. Very fine, full-bodied and mellow, their sap and their very pronounced aromatic bouquet were bound to make them inimitable…” Yet the following quotation shows that, at all times, the wines of “l’Hermitage”, renowned for their inimitable quality, have been the object of counterfeiting or usurpation. Thus, Boileau wrote in 1665 in his Satire III, Le Festin ridicule: “An impudent lackey brings me a brimming glass of a smoky auvernat which, mixed with lineage, was sold at Crenet’s as wine of the Ermitage.”

XI. – Transitional measures

The parcels of vines in place on 31 July 2009 and not meeting the provisions relating to the minimum planting density and to the distance between rows or the spacing between plants within the same row continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin, until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2040 harvest inclusive, provided that the foliage height makes it possible to have 1.40 square metre of external surface of plant cover for the production of one kilogram of grapes.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Hermitage” or “l’Hermitage”, with or without an “H”, is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille” are compulsorily presented with the indication of the vintage.

b) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that: - it is a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appears on the harvest declaration.

c) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit “Cru des Côtes du Rhône” or “Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône”. The conditions of use of the larger geographical unit “Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône” are specified by the agreement signed between the various defence and management bodies concerned. This term must appear in the same visual field as all the compulsory indications, and be printed in characters of the same graphics and the same colour as those of the appellation, without the dimensions of this term exceeding two-thirds of those of the appellation.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, according to the arrangements defined in the control plan, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin. This declaration, drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body, specifies for each parcel whether they are intended for the production of a more general controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

2. Declarations relating to the production of the wines liable to benefit from the term "vin de paille"

Every operator lodges with the defence and management body: - a declaration of intention to produce wines liable to benefit from the term "vin de paille", according to the arrangements defined in the control plan; - a declaration of intention to press according to the arrangements defined in the control/inspection plan. These declarations are drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

3. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before the first bulk transaction or bulk sale to the consumer, or before the first packaging, and at the latest five days after the deadline for lodging the harvest declaration. The claim declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body. It indicates: - the designation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine.

4. Declaration of bulk transaction or of bulk sale to the consumer and declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

A declaration of bulk transaction, or a declaration of bulk sale to the consumer, is sent to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration specifies, where applicable, whether the non-packaged wine is intended to be dispatched outside the national territory. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the approved control body.

5. Packaging declaration

Every operator having carried out a packaging of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make, to the approved control body, a packaging declaration according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. The packaging declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the approved control body.

6. Fallback (repli) declaration (marketing under a more general appellation)

Every operator carrying out a fallback of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

7. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

8. Declaration relating to the modification of the elements structuring the viticultural landscape

Before any development or any works modifying the structuring elements (low walls, terraces, embankments, banks, etc.) of a delimited parcel, a declaration is sent by the operator to the defence and management body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. The defence and

management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

II. – Keeping of registers

No specific provision.

CHAPTER III

I – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A. – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A.1. Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary check and/or check in the field
A.2. Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of derogatory measures, planting density and trellising)	Documentary check and/or check in the field
A.3. Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vinification capacity	Documentary check and/or check in the field
Place of vinification	Documentary check
Identified storage place for the packaged products	Documentary check and/or check in the field
B. – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B.1. Management of the vineyard. — Pruning	Check in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation condition and other cultivation practices	Check in the field
B.2. Harvest and ripeness of the grapes. — Particular harvesting provisions	Check in the field
Ripeness of the grapes	Documentary check and check in the field
Monitoring of the rules relating to the production of the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”	Documentary check and check in the field
B.3. Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Pressing of the wines liable to benefit from the term “vin de paille”	Documentary check and check in the field
Blends	Documentary check and check in the field
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	Documentary check and check in the field
Stock accounts, traceability	Documentary check
B.4. Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines	Documentary check and check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check
Claim declaration	Documentary check
C. – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
At the stage of the placing into circulation of the products between approved warehouse keepers (at transaction). At the stage of placing on the market for the consumer, before or after packaging	Analytical and organoleptic examination

Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots

II – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out on the basis of an approved control plan and by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, having received delegation from the INAO.